



May 28th 2019 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ghb-Y2xI1D4
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer. Opening procedures included the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:35](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Alexander, Mr. Lewin (Chambers), Miss Lassiter, Mr. Piper (and other council members including Mr. Ballard, Mr. Franklin/Frankenfish).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in the opening transcript text, though Mr. Alexander and other board members actively guided proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:35](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the April 23rd meeting were approved via roll call vote [00:01:52](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:02:45](#) **Tax Abatement Request: Magna Powertrain**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tracy Lawton (Muncie Delaware County Economic Development Alliance) and Steven Brand (Plant Manager).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Magna requested tax abatement for a new \$9 million investment in equipment for a new assembly line (transfer cases for four-wheel-drive powertrains). The project will create 50 new jobs (averaging \$17.37/hour, well above the county manufacturing average) while retaining 461 existing employees. The current assessed value of the plant is \$27.17 million.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution 2019-01 approved by roll call vote [00:09:39](#).
- [00:10:33](#) **Tax Abatement Request: Midwest Metal Products Company**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Economic Development Alliance) and Chad Smith (CFO, Midwest Metal Products).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for a 5-year phased tax abatement on a new mesh welding machine valued at \$1,323,000, replacing an outdated 20-year-old machine. The company has operated in Delaware County for 98 years, employs 157 people (80% from Delaware County), and offers health insurance. The 5-year abatement totals \$47,510, resulting in a net cash revenue positive to the county of \$71,590 over 10 years.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:14:21](#).
- [00:15:19](#) **Financial Transfers & Additional Appropriations**
 - **Planning Commission ([00:15:19](#)):** Request for \$4,975 to reimburse an employee whose paycheck was misdirected due to an email/HR hacking incident.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:27:13](#).
 - **Prosecutor State Seizure Funding ([00:27:43](#)):** Request for \$3,000.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **Community Corrections ([00:28:18](#)):** Annual budget adjustments (shifting to fiscal year matching county budget).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:29:28](#).
 - **Surveyor Health Insurance ([00:29:56](#)):** Request for \$562.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:30:24](#).
 - **Coroner Equipment ([00:31:56](#)):** Copy fees / equipment request for \$1,800.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:32:52](#).
 - **EMS Capital Improvements & Adjustments ([00:33:04](#)):** Multiple requests including FICA shortfalls (\$1,912.50), 6 portable radios (\$23,101.32), and an ambulance chassis change order (\$5,247) due to unexpected floor repairs during a remount.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** All approved via roll call votes.
 - **Jail / Sheriff / Public Defender / Communications Transfers:** Various line-item adjustments, temporary secretary funds, and personnel line corrections.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call votes throughout the session.
- [00:46:46](#) **Sheriff's Salary Contract & Resolution**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Liaison Scott, Mr. Hughes, and Sheriff John Brooks.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion and finalization of the statutory sheriff's salary contract and accompanying resolution following Indiana code requirements. Council members raised broader concerns regarding long-term pension liabilities (PERF) and fiscal sustainability under property tax caps.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution approving the salary contract approved by roll call vote [00:55:27](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:55:49](#) **Resident / Attendee:** Spoke to recognize and praise Salem Township EMS and Fire for their handling of severe weather and a recent apparatus accident. Also commended county emergency management (Jason Rogers) and the Sheriff's Department for their rapid storm response.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Discussion regarding annual department head introductory letters and signatures [00:57:18](#).
 - Extended board commentary regarding public safety, historical cooperation (and recent friction) between the City of Muncie and the county regarding the 911 communication center and EMS operations [00:58:07](#).
- **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following final remarks and voice concurrence [10:05:39](#).